CERTIFICATION OF ETHICS AGREEMENT COMPLIANCE

Senate Confirmed Presidential Appointee

1. Appointee's Information	a. Appointee's Name:	to be completed by OGE Thomas J. Vilsack
	b. Position Title:	to be completed by OGE Secretary
	c. Agency:	to be completed by OGE Department of Agriculture
	d. Date Ethics Agreement Signed:	to be completed by OGE January 14, 2021
	e. Date Confirmed:	to be completed by OGE February 23, 2021
	f. Due Date for Certification of Ethics Agreement Compliance:	to be completed by OGE May 31, 2021
2. Resignations	*I completed all of the resignations indicated in my ethics agreement before I assumed the duties of my current government position.*	◉ Yes ○ No ○ N/A
3. Divestitures	a. *I have completed all of the divestitures indicated in my ethics agreement. I also understand that I may not repurchase these assets during my appointment without OGE's prior approval.*	○ Yes ○ No ◉ N/A
	b. *I have filed a periodic transaction report, or periodic transaction reports, (OGE Form-T) to disclose the completion of these agreed upon divestitures.*	○ Yes ○ No ◉ N/A Filing Date(s) of OGE Form 278-T Report(s):
4. Managed Accounts	*If I have a managed account or use the services of an investment professional, I have notified the manager or professional of the limitations indicated in my ethics agreement. In addition, I am continuing to monitor purchases.*	◉ Yes ○ No ○ N/A
5. Interim Recusals	*I complied with my interim recusal obligations pending the divestitures required by my ethics agreement.*	○ Yes ○ No ◉ N/A

6. Recusals *(Note: These factual statements describe the appointee's current status. They are not intended to modify ethics agreement commitments or create new recusal obligations.)*	a. *I will continue to recuse from particular matters in which I know I have a personal or imputed financial interest directly and predictably affected by the matter, unless I receive a waiver or qualify for a regulatory exemption.*	◉ Yes ○ No
	b. *I am recusing from particular matters in which any former employer or client I served in the past year is a party or represents a party, unless I have been authorized under 5 C.F.R. § 2635.502(d).*	◉ Yes ○ No ○ N/A
	c. *I am recusing from particular matters in which any former employer or client I served in the two years prior to my appointment is a party or represents a party, unless I have received a waiver under Exec. Order 13989.*	◉ Yes ○ No ○ N/A
7. Waivers and Authorizations **(Consult with your agency's DAEO if uncertain under what authority a waiver or authorization was granted.)**	a. *I received a waiver pursuant to 18 U.S.C. § 208.* If yes, indicate the date of the waiver and indicate the financial interest covered by the waiver.	◉ Yes ○ No Date: February 23, 2021 Financial interest: CRP Payments
	b. *I received a waiver pursuant to Executive Order 13989.* If yes, indicate the date of the waiver and the subject of the waiver (i.e., applicable paragraph of the ethics pledge, parties, particular matters, specific issue areas, as applicable).	○ Yes ◉ No Date: Subject:
	c. *I received an authorization pursuant to 5 C.F.R. § 2635.502(d).* If yes, indicate date of authorization and identify the covered person(s) as to whom you have been authorized (e.g., former employer, former client, spouse's employer, spouse's current client, etc.).	○ Yes ◉ No Date: Covered person(s):
	d. *I received a waiver pursuant to 5 C.F.R. § 2635.503(c).* If yes, indicate the date of the waiver and identify the former employer or payer.	○ Yes ◉ No Date: Former employer or payer:

8. Payments, Accelerations, or Divestitures Required to be Completed Prior to Entering Government Service	Mark this box if not applicable: ☑	a. *If I committed that I would forfeit a financial interest or payment, unless it was received or accelerated prior to my assumption of the duties of the government position:*	○ *I received it (or it was accelerated) prior to my assumption of the duties of the position.* ○ *I received it (or if was accelerated after my assumption of the duties of the position.* ○ *I forfeited it.*
		b. Financial interest or payment at issue:	
9. Requirements for Regular Appointees	*I have completed my initial ethics briefing, pursuant to 5 C.F.R. § 2638.305.* If you are a Special Government Employee (SGE) or career Foreign Service Officer (FSO), select N/A.		● Yes ○ No ○ N/A
	I have signed the ethics pledge pursuant to Executive Order 13989. If you are a SGE or career FSO or previously signed the pledge, select N/A.		● Yes ○ No ○ N/A
10. Additional Ethics Agreement Requirements	to be completed by OGE		to be completed by appointee *I am complying with these requirements as described in the adjacent box.* ○ Yes ○ No ● N/A
11. Comments of Appointee	To ensure that I was apprised of the ethics rules at the very beginning of my public service as Secretary of Agriculture in the Biden Administration, I directed USDA's Designated Agency Ethics Official to provide me with live ethics training a few hours after my Senate confirmation on February 23, 2021.		

Any intentionally false or misleading statement or response provided in this certification is a violation of law punishable by a fine or imprisonment, or both, under 18 U.S.C. § 1001.

I certify that the information I have provided is complete and accurate.	Appointee's Signature:	Date: 4-5-21

Privacy Act Statement	Section 110 of the Ethics in Government Act of 1978, as amended, requires the reporting of this information. The primary use of the information on this report is for review by Government officials to determine an appointee's compliance with applicable Federal laws and regulations, and the appointee's Ethics Agreement. Failure to provide the requested information may result in notification of lack of compliance to the Senate and the head of the appointee's agency, or the White House, and/or could result in OGE declining to certify the appointee's financial disclosure reports. The appointee could also be required to recuse from matters based on uncertainty as to whether they have divested or resigned from a matter determined to raise potential conflicts. This information will be publically posted to the OGE website at www.oge.gov in accordance with OGE/GOVT-1, Executive Branch Personnel Public Financial Disclosure Reports and Other Name-Retrieved Ethics Program Records (routine use "k."). Please see OGE/GOVT-1 for more information about the maintenance and disclosure of this information.
Filing the Certification of Ethics Agreement Compliance	Your position as one of our government's most senior leaders brings with it extraordinary responsibilities. One of those responsibilities is to serve as a role model for all executive branch employees by demonstrating a commitment to ethical principles and actively seeking to avoid conflicts of interest. This includes compliance with the ethics agreement you signed prior to and as a condition of your confirmation. By signing this Certification of Ethics Agreement Compliance (Certification) you certify that you have complied with the terms of your ethics agreement. The information below is intended to help you timely meet your obligation to complete and submit this form to the U.S. Office of Government Ethics (OGE). You are required to comply with the provisions of your ethics agreement within three months of the date of your confirmation, unless otherwise specified. Please: • Review your ethics agreement carefully. • If your ethics agreement requires you to resign from an outside position, please note that resignations are generally required "upon confirmation." • Identify any provisions of your ethics agreement that may require coordination with an account manager or other third party. • Initiate any necessary action early enough to timely comply with your ethics agreement. • If you qualify for and wish to request a Certificate of Divestiture, please submit your request as soon as possible through your agency's Designated Agency Ethics Official (DAEO). If your ethics agreement specifies that you have more than three months to comply with a particular provision, you must still comply with the remaining provisions within the standard three-month period and submit a Certification (through your agency's DAEO) within seven days thereafter. If you have not complied with a provision of your ethics agreement, please provide an explanation in Box 11, Comments of Appointee. You will be provided with an additional Certification to complete and submit to OGE to certify that you have complied with all provisions of your ethics agreement. **Extensions:** OGE may grant an extension of time for complying with a provision of your ethics agreement if, in its sole discretion, it determines that an unusual hardship has/will prevent you from complying timely. Generally, waiting for an account manager to sell an interest, not being able to locate records, or waiting for OGE to process a request for a Certificate of Divestiture are not considered unusual hardships. As noted in the Privacy Act Statement above, not submitting your Certification may result in notification of lack of compliance to the Senate, the head of your agency, or the White House. OGE may also decline to certify your financial disclosure reports. You may also be required to recuse from matters based on uncertainty as to whether they have divested or resigned from a matter determined to raise potential conflicts. OGE may also post a notice on its website, in place of your Certification, stating that you have not yet submitted the required certification. **While it is your personal responsibility to take the steps necessary to comply with your ethics agreement, your agency's DAEO is available to assist you in completing this Certification and submitting it to OGE. Any questions you may have should be directed to your agency's DAEO.**